

fruits, at least ½in (1cm) in diameter, which are at their best in winter. Z10–12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

S. crispum ‘Glasnevin’ illus. p.204.

S. jasminoides. See *S. laxum*.

S. laxum, syn. *S. jasminoides* (Potato vine). Semievergreen, woody-stemmed, scrambling climber. H to 20ft (6m). Ovate to lance-shaped leaves may be lobed or have leaflets at base. Small, 5-petaled, pale gray-blue flowers are borne in summer–fall, followed by tiny, black berries. Z7–10. **‘Album’** illus. p.195.

S. pseudocapsicum (Jerusalem cherry). Fairly slow-growing, evergreen, bushy shrub, usually grown as an annual. H and S to 4ft (1.2m). Has ovate or lance-shaped, bright green leaves. Small, star-shaped, white flowers are borne in summer and are followed by spherical, scarlet fruits. Z10–12 (min. 41°F/5°C). Has several smaller selections: **‘Balloon’** illus. p.327; **‘Fancy’**, H 1ft (30cm), with scarlet fruits; **‘Joker’** has yellow fruit turning orange and red; **‘Red Giant’** has large orange-red fruit, to 1in (2.5cm) across; and **‘Snowfire’**, H 1ft (30cm), with white fruits that later turn red.

S. rantonnei. See *Lycianthes rantonnetii*.

S. rantonnetii. See *Lycianthes rantonnetii*.

S. seaforthianum (Italian jasmine) illus. p.463.

S. wendlandii illus. p.463.

SOLDANELLA

Snowbell

PRIMULACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials, grown for their early spring flowers. Suitable for rock gardens, troughs, and alpine houses. Fully hardy, but flower buds are set in fall and may be destroyed by frost in areas where there is no snow cover. Needs partial shade and humus-rich, well-drained, peaty soil. Propagate by seed in spring or by division in late summer. Slugs may cause damage to flower buds.

S. alpina (Alpine snowbell) illus. p.354.

S. minima (Least snowbell). Evergreen, prostrate perennial. H 1in (2.5cm), S 4in (10cm). Forms a mat of minute, rounded leaves on soil surface. In early spring, produces solitary almost stemless, bell-shaped, pale lavender-blue or white flowers with fringed petals. Z4–7

S. montana (Mountain tassel). Evergreen, mound-forming perennial. H 4in (10cm), S 6in (15cm). In early spring, tall flower stems bear long, pendent, bell-shaped, lavender-blue flowers with fringed mouths. Leaves are rounded and leathery. Z4–7

S. villosa illus. p.354.

SOLEIROLIA

Baby’s tears, Mind-your-own-business, Mother of thousands

URTICACEAE

Genus of one species of usually evergreen, prostrate perennial that forms a dense carpet of foliage. Frost hardy, although leaves are killed by winter frost. Recovers to grow vigorously again in spring. Tolerates sun or shade, and prefers moist soil. Propagate by division from spring to midsummer.

S. soleirolii, syn. *Helxine soleirolii*, illus. p.283.

SOLENOSTEMON

syn. COLEUS

Flame nettle, Painted nettle

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of evergreen, bushy, subshrubby perennials, grown for their colorful leaves and flowers. Excellent as potted plants. Frost tender. Grow in sun or partial shade and in fertile, well-drained soil, in a sheltered site. Water freely in summer, much less at other times. Pinch out growing shoots of young plants to encourage a bushy habit. Propagate by seed sown under glass in spring or by softwood cuttings in spring or summer. Mealy bugs and whitefly may cause problems.

S. blumei var. verschaffeltii. See *S. scutellarioides*.

S. ‘Chocolate Mint’ illus. p.311.

S. scutellarioides, syn. *Coleus scutellarioides*, *Plectranthus scutellarioides*, *S. blumei* var. *verschaffeltii*. Fast-growing, bushy perennial, grown as an annual. H to 1½ft (45cm), S 1ft (30cm) or more. Broadly to narrowly ovate, toothed leaves are a mixture of colors, including pink, red, green, or yellow. Flower spikes should be removed. Z10–12 (min. 39°F/4°C).

‘Inky Fingers’ illus. p.310. **Wizard Series**, H to 8in (20cm), is compact and bushy, with small, strongly colored leaves, to 2in (5cm) long.

S. thyrsoides. See *Plectranthus thyrsoides*.

SOLIDAGO

Golden rod

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of summer- and fall-flowering, woody-based perennials, some species of which are vigorous, coarse plants that tend to crowd out others in borders. Best in a wild garden, although *S. virgaurea* subsp. *minuta* is suitable for a rock garden, trough, or alpine house. Fully hardy. Most tolerate sun or shade and any well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring. Occasionally self-seeds.

S. ‘Goldenmosa’ illus. p.251.

S. ‘Golden Wings’. Upright perennial. H 5ft (1.5m), S 3ft (1m). Has lance-shaped, toothed, hairy, mid-green leaves. Produces large, feathery panicles of small, bright yellow flower heads in late summer and early fall. Z3–8

S. ‘Laurin’. Compact perennial. H 2–2½ft (60–75cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has mid-green leaves and bears spikes of deep yellow flowers in late summer. Z3–8

S. x luteus, syn. *x Solidaster hybridus*, *x S. luteus*, illus. p.275.

S. virgaurea subsp. minuta, syn. *S.v. subsp. alpestris*. Mound-forming perennial. H and S 4in (10cm). Has small, leathery, lance-shaped, toothed, mid-green leaves. From late summer to fall, bears neat spikes of small, yellow flower heads. Needs shade and moist soil. Z3–8

x Solidaster hybridus. See *Solidago x hybridus*.

x Solidaster luteus. See *Solidago x luteus*.

SOLLYA

Bluebell creeper

PITTOSPORACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-based, twining climbers, grown for their attractive flowers. Frost hardy. Grow in sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring, or by softwood or greenwood cuttings in summer.

S. heterophylla illus. p.194.

SONERILA

MELASTOMATACEAE

Genus of evergreen, bushy perennials and shrubs, grown for their foliage and flowers. Frost tender. Prefers a humid atmosphere in partial shade and peaty soil. Propagate by tip cuttings in spring.

S. margaritacea. Evergreen, bushy, semi-prostrate perennial. H and S 8–10in (20–25cm). Red stems have ovate, dark green leaves, 2–3in (5–8cm) long, reddish below, silver-patterned above. Bears racemes of 3-petaled, rose-pink flowers in summer. Z12 (min. 19°C/66°F).

‘Argentea’ has more silvery leaves with green veins; **‘Hendersonii’** is more compact with white-spotted leaves.

SOPHORA

Kowhai

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of herbaceous perennnials and deciduous or evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their habit, foliage and pealike flowers. Fully to frost hardy. Needs full sun (*S. microphylla* and *S. tetraptera* are best grown against a warm, sunny wall) and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall; semievergreens may be raised from cuttings in summer.

S. davidii, syn. *S. viciifolia*, illus. p.138.

S. japonica. See *Styphnolobium japonicum*.

S. SUN KING (‘Hilsop’). Semievergreen, bushy tree. H and S 10ft (3m). Dark green leaves are composed of numerous tiny, oblong leaflets. Produces long-lasting, pealike, dark yellow flowers in late winter and early spring. Z7–11

S. tetraptera illus. p.84.

S. viciifolia. See *S. davidii*.

x Sophrolaeliocattleya Hazel Boyd ‘Apricot Glow’. See *x Cattlianthe Hazel Boyd* gx ‘Apricot Glow’.

SORBARIA

ROSACEAE

Genus of deciduous, summer-flowering shrubs, grown for their foliage and large panicles of small, white flowers. Suitable for a large border, or a wild or woodland garden. Fully hardy. Prefers sun and deep, fertile, moist soil. In winter, cut out some older stems on mature plants and prune back remaining shoots to growing points. Remove suckers at base to prevent plants spreading too widely. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer, division in fall, or by root cuttings in late winter.

S. aitchisonii. See *S. tomentosa* var. *angustifolia*.

SORBUS

S. arborea. See *S. kirilowii*.

S. kirilowii, syn. *S. arborea*, *Spiraea arborea*, illus. p.128.

S. sorbifolia, syn. *Spiraea sorbifolia*, illus. p.129. **‘Sem’** is a compact shrub. H and S 5ft (1.5m). Has pinkish red young leaves, that change to yellow-green with bronze tips, then dark green, and finally turn reddish in fall. Flowers are produced from mid- to late summer. Z2–7

S. tomentosa var. angustifolia, syn. *S. aitchisonii*, *Spiraea aitchisonii*. Deciduous, arching shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Shoots are red when young. Leaves have 11–23 narrowly lance-shaped, taper-pointed, dark green leaflets. Upright panicles of star-shaped, white flowers are produced from mid- to late summer. Z2–7

SORBUS

ROSACEAE

Genus of deciduous trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage, corymbs of small, 5-petaled flowers, attractive fruits and, in some species, fall color. Leaves may be whole or divided into leaflets. Fully to frost hardy. Needs sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained but moist soil. Species with leaves composed of leaflets do not grow well in very dry soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings or budding in summer, by seed in fall, or by grafting in winter. Susceptible to fireblight. ☉ Raw fruit may cause mild stomach upset if ingested.

S. alnifolia (orean mountain ash). Deciduous, conical, then spreading tree. H 50ft (15m), S 25ft (8m). Ovate to lance-shaped, toothed, dark green leaves turn orange and red in fall. Bears small, white flowers in mid-spring, followed by spherical, deep pink to red berries. Z3–7

S. aria (Whitebeam). Deciduous, spreading tree. H 50ft (15m), S 30ft (10m). Ovate, toothed leaves are silver-gray when young, maturing to dark green above, white-felted beneath. Bears small, white flowers in late spring, followed by ovoid to spherical, brown-speckled, deep red berries. H6. **‘Chrysophylla’**, H 30ft (10m), S 22ft (7m), has golden-yellow young leaves. **‘Decaisneana’** see *S.a. ‘Majestica’*.

‘Lutescens’ (illus. p.91) is compact, with silvery-gray, later gray-green foliage and orange-red berries. **‘Majestica’** (syn. *S.a. ‘Decaisneana’*) has larger leaves, white-haired when young.

S. aucuparia (Mountain ash, Rowan; illus. p.91). Deciduous, spreading tree. H 50ft (15m), S 22ft (7m). Pinnate leaves have up to 17 oblong-lance-shaped, mid-green leaflets that turn red or yellow in fall. Bears white flowers in spring, then spherical, orange-red berries. Z3–7.

‘Fastigiata’ (syn. *S. scopulina* of gardens), H 25ft (8m), S 15ft (5m), is conical, with upright branches, dark green leaves, and dark red berries. **‘Fructu Luteo’** see var. *xanthocarpa*. **‘Sheerwater Seedling’**, S 12ft (4m), has a narrow, upright habit.

var. xanthocarpa (syn. *S.a. ‘Fructu Luteo’*), H and S 25ft (8m), is spreading, with orange-yellow berries.

S. AUTUMN SPIRE (‘Flanrock’). Compact, columnar tree. H 12–15ft (4–5m), S 3–5ft (1–1.5m). Pinnate leaves with 15–21 narrowly oblong, dark green leaflets, turn orange and purplish-red in fall. Bears white flowers in late spring, followed by